

Findin

A WHERE and WHEN guessing game for living and extinct animals, built around reproducible daily puzzles and cautious scientific content handling.

Role: builder (ownership pending confirmation)

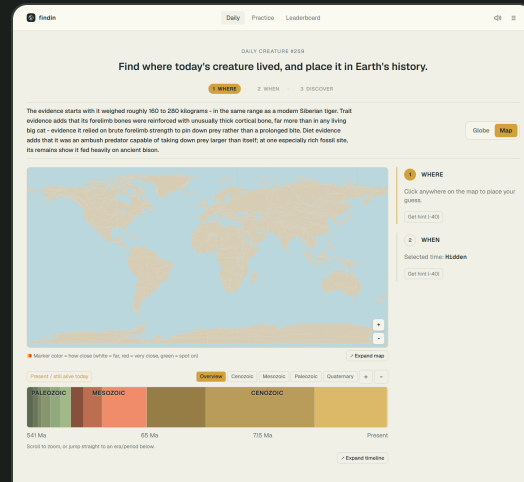
Live: findin.world

Private full-stack product

Next.js

TypeScript

Supabase



Real local Daily screen, captured from the running app. The same build is live at findin.world.

60

species verified for launch

31

static pages in the production build

350

passing tests, 58 test files

SYSTEM SUMMARY

Provider sources
GBIF, PBDB,
GPLates



Offline ingestion
+ quality gates



Supabase catalog

Browser (Daily /
Practice)



Server-authoritative
routes



Frozen Daily
snapshot

KEY ENGINEERING DECISIONS

- Persist a Daily puzzle row with a frozen animal snapshot, so a player never sees the answer move underneath them.
- Run ingestion, rescue, and validation offline so gameplay never depends on live provider calls.
- Cache GPLates-derived coastlines and fossil coordinates ahead of time, with fallback to the modern map for unsupported ages.
- Apply a hard no-repeat Daily rotation before scoring the remaining candidates for balance.

LIMITATIONS

- Live and playable, but not presented as a launch with proven traction.
- At the 16 September snapshot, 80 of 578 staged candidates were published/playable; the Daily-ready pool is smaller still.
- The globe view is experimental; the map/timeline flow is the production-safe claim.

DATA + QUALITY

- Provider evidence is normalized and gated through explicit content states before it can become playable.
- Quality gates cover taxonomy, WHERE, WHEN, paleo support, media, and Field Notes.

WHAT IT DEMONSTRATES

Turning messy scientific data into something that has to be right — offline ingestion and validation, server-authoritative game state, and being explicit about which surfaces are production-safe versus experimental.

Test and build figures verified 2 October 2026. Public-safe case study. No app source code, credentials, private repository links, account identifiers, or internal deployment identifiers included.